



ROUTEUP CAREER GUIDANCE SERIES — VOLUME 9

From Student to Permanent Residency

The Long Game Most Students Discover Too Late

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PR Is Designed Backwards From Day One

Permanent residency is not something you look into after graduation. The course you pick, the occupation it maps to, your work experience during and after study, even your English scores — the PR system was scoring you before you boarded the flight. Students who learn the rules at the end usually discover they broke them at the beginning.

Myth: “Finish studies first, think about PR later.”

Reality: In points-based systems, your course choice determines your nominated occupation, which determines whether PR is even possible. A course chosen for easy admission can map to an occupation with no pathway at all.

Myth: “PR rules are stable — what worked for my senior will work for me.”

Reality: Every major destination tightened between 2024 and 2026: Canada is reforming Express Entry to favour high-wage occupations; the UK Graduate route shortens to 18 months from 2027; Australia doubled the 485 fee and cut its age limit to 35. Your senior's 2021 roadmap is a historical document.

Myth: “Switching courses or colleges doesn't affect PR.”

Reality: Immigration officers examine your study history at PR stage. Unexplained switches — especially downgrades to cheaper colleges — read as visa-driven decisions and invite refusals. The straight line follows you all the way to the end.

The Honest Pathway Map (July 2026)

- **Canada:** PGWP up to 3 years → 1 year skilled work → Express Entry. Clearest pipeline of all — but reforms will favour higher-paid occupations, so the job you take on PGWP now matters more than ever.
- **Australia:** study → 485 (18 months–3 years, fee now A\$4,600, age cap 35 for most) → points-based 189/190. Your points are yours: age, English, experience, qualifications. No employer can hold them hostage — but competition rises every round.
- **UK:** study → Graduate route (18 months from 2027) → Skilled Worker sponsorship (~£41,700 or going rate) → settlement after 5 years. Works well for high earners; the salary bar is the filter.
- **Germany:** study or Opportunity Card → job → Blue Card → PR in as little as 21–27 months with German language. The quiet achiever of this list — language is the toll gate.
- **USA:** world-best salaries, decades-long green card queue for Indian-born applicants. Go for the earnings and experience with open eyes; do not plan family life around a green card date nobody can promise.

What consultancies won't tell you: 'guaranteed PR' is the most expensive lie in this industry, because it's sold at the END of your journey when you've already spent the most and fear losing it. PR decisions are made by governments on published criteria. Pay for honest advice about your points and options — never for a 'guarantee'.

Worksheet — My PR Reality Check

☐ My course maps to this occupation on the destination's skilled list:

☐ The post-study visa I'll hold, and its exact duration:

☐ What I must achieve DURING that visa to qualify for the next stage:

- ☐ My realistic points score today (age, English, education, experience):

 - ☐ My plan still works if the rules tighten another 10–20% (buffer, not bare minimum)
 - ☐ I have a Plan B country or pathway if my first choice closes
 - ☐ Nothing in my study history will need an awkward explanation at PR stage
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When to Get Help

Everything in this volume you can act on yourself — that is deliberate. But the worksheet you just filled has answers only YOU could write, and validating those answers against real requirements, real budgets, and real immigration rules is where mistakes hide.

Bring your completed PR reality check to session with RouteUp. We will go through it line by line and tell you honestly — including if your plan is fine and you don't need us further.

Book your free session: www.routeup.co.in · hello@routeup.co.in ·

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